

1. Can you describe your role in relation to the research project or projects you have been involved in?

I was the lead for the Bakery project. That meant keeping the team focused, making decisions when things were unclear, and making sure the final submission was completed.

2. At the start of the project, what guidance were you given about how you were expected to document your research work? Can you give an example?

The guidance was very general. We were told documentation is important and that we should use something like GitHub or a shared drive, but there was no clear explanation of what needed to be documented or what would actually be enough. So we mostly treated documentation as producing the final report.

3. Can you describe specific situations where documentation came up during the project work? What happened in those moments?

When reviewing earlier parts of the project, we sometimes noticed that certain choices were never clearly recorded. At the time everything felt obvious, but later it was harder to explain why we had moved in a particular direction.

4. Based on the final outputs of projects, how usable do you think they are for someone new who has not spoken to the original team? Can you give an example?

The report can be understood, but continuing the work would be difficult without speaking to the team. Key steps behind the conclusions are not always visible, so someone new would likely need additional explanation before building on it

5. Which parts would be difficult for someone new to understand based only on what is written down or stored?

What tends to stay unclear is why certain directions were chosen along the way. Many of those decisions happened during team discussions and were not fully captured, which makes the project harder to interpret afterwards.

6. Can you think of an example of an important decision or change during the project, and describe how and where it was documented, if at all?

Partway through the project, we reduced the scope because of time and access constraints. That shift was agreed in conversations, but it was never clearly documented, so you only notice it when comparing earlier work with the final version.

7. If someone new wanted to understand how one important conclusion was reached, what would they need to look at or read?

To trace one conclusion back properly, you would need access to notes, draft material, and the earlier inputs that informed it. Since those were not kept together in one place, most people would probably rely on the team to explain it.

8. During the project, was it clear who was responsible for documenting what, if anyone? How was that responsibility communicated or decided?

No, that was not clear. People managed their own material, but no one coordinated how decisions or progress were recorded, so the structure depended largely on individual work and group sessions.

9. What tools, templates, or systems were used to document work, and where was everything stored in practice?

We used a mix of tools. Documents and slides, sometimes GitHub, sometimes shared drives, and also notes in messages or personal files. Where something was stored depended on who created it.

10. What do you think the purpose of documentation is in these projects? Who do you think benefits from it, if anyone? And what, if anything, motivates students to document their work well?

Documentation helps others understand what was done and continue the work later. Future students, supervisors, and stakeholders would likely benefit from that. When most attention goes to finishing the final output, documenting the process naturally becomes less of a priority.

11. Based on your experience, what tends to get lost most often over time, for example context, assumptions, decisions, data, analysis steps, or contacts?

Early context tends to disappear first, especially the discussions that influenced key decisions. Intermediate steps are often harder to trace later, and contact details sometimes remain in personal inboxes. What usually stays is the final version, without much insight into how it developed.

12. How did documentation fit into the project work overall? Did it feel integrated into the work, or more like something added on top? Why?

It felt added on top. The priority was delivering the final output. Documentation was something you did afterwards or when someone asked for it. There was no workflow that naturally integrated documentation into daily work.

13. If you were starting the project again, what would you personally do differently in how you document your work?

I would keep it simple but consistent from the start. A clear expectation of how and what to do, including where to store it and making that part of the requirement for passing would allow that to become a part of the learning process. Maybe include everyone's personal work and notes as well.

14. Is there anything about documentation, continuity, or research practice that we have not discussed but that you think is important?

Yes, I think relying on previous students for explanations is also difficult, so having a basic standard would make projects easier to understand without needing the students to give understanding to the project.